

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦ 3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠ J

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣ 5

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4 ♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣ K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 2
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q 10 7 4
 ♣ A J 8 7 5

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A K 5 3

♦ J 8

♣ 6 4



♠ Q J 3
 ♥ 10 9 8 2
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ K 3 2

♠ A 7 5

♥ Q J 6

♦ A K 5 2

♣ Q 10 9

Because NORTH holds a 4-card Major suit, (♥s), he starts his responses with Stayman.

SOUTH denies holding any 4-card Major suit so NORTH gives up on ♥s. He next bids ♠s, showing five of them. He jumps to 3♠, giving SOUTH the choice between 4♠ or 3NT.

With three trumps SOUTH chooses 4♠.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ 3			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 6 5

♥ K 7 6 4

♦ A 3 2

♣ 5 4

♠ 10 4 2

♥ 9 3

♦ Q 9 6 4

♣ 9 8 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 7 3

♥ Q J 2

♦ J 5

♣ K Q J 6

♠ J 9

♥ A 10 8 5

♦ K 10 8 7

♣ A 10 3

WEST has a poor 9 points, but does have two 4-card Majors. So he uses Stayman.

When EAST bids ♠s, WEST isn't strong enough to bid game herself, so she temporizes with a 3♠ invitation.

EAST has a full 17 points so he accepts the invitation.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♠J

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 4
 ♥ 10 8 6 4 3 2
 ♦ 7 6 3 2
 ♣ 5

♠ J 10 8 7 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q 5

♣ 10 7 2



♠ A 3 2

♥ K J

♦ J 8 4

♣ A K 9 6 3

♠ K Q

♥ A Q 7 5

♦ K 10 9

♣ Q J 8 4

NORTH, with 9 points and a 6-card suit, knows they should play in ♠s. The question is: how high?

NORTH transfers SOUTH to ♠s, then invites by raising to 3♠.

SOUTH has only two trumps, (good ones, admittedly), but she has a maximum 17 point hand. So she bids the ♠ game.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣5			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2
 ♥ Q J 10 7 5
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ 8 3

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ 8
 ♦ 10 7 5 4 3
 ♣ K Q J 5



♠ K J 5
 ♥ A K 6
 ♦ A Q 2
 ♣ 10 7 6 2

♠ 10 9 8
 ♥ 9 4 3 2
 ♦ J 9 8
 ♣ A 9 4

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♣K			

WEST, with a 5-card AND a 4-card Major first uses Stayman.

EAST denies a 4-card Major, so WEST realizes that ♠s are out. He then bids ♥s, promising five of them.

EAST not only has three ♥s, she also has 17 points so she bids 4♥.